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trn:oid:::9832:155732386

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**File Name**
Mini_Project_Report_Formatted(1).docx

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26,004 Characters

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Development of Indigenous Contactless ITMS – TR-09 Prototype

**SVKM'S NARSEE MONJEE INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT STUDIES**

**Mukesh Patel School of Technology Management & Engineering**

Shirpur Campus, Maharashtra

**TECHNICAL PROJECT REPORT**

# DEVELOPMENT OF INDIGENOUS CONTACTLESS INTEGRATED TRACK MONITORING SYSTEMS (ITMS)

*TR-09 Prototype: Architecture, Working Principle, and Technical Validation*

*A Technical Project Report submitted in partial fulfilment of the requirements for*

**Course: Design Experience**

**Programme: MBA Tech & B.Tech Computer Engineering – Second Year**

Batch: 2024–2029|Academic Year: 2025–26

| **Submitted By:** | **Under the Guidance of:** |
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**October 2026**

# Certificate of Approval

This certifies that the Technical Project Report entitled 'Development of Indigenous Contactless Integrated Track Monitoring Systems (ITMS) – TR-09 Prototype' is a true and accurate account of the work carried out by Soham Bhosale, Arnav and Rudra Marathe (Second Year MBA Tech & B.Tech Computer Engineering students at the Mukesh Patel School of Technology Management & Engineering, SVKM's NMIMS, Shirpur) under my supervision and guidance as part of the Design Experience for the academic year 2025-26.

The project is a fully functional, low cost contactless track inspection system designed to RDSO Indian Railways broad gauge standards.

| | |
|---|---|
| **Prof. Chaitali Patil**<br>Project Mentor,<br>MPSTME | **Head of Department**<br>Computer Engineering,<br>MPSTME |
| | |
| **External Examiner** | Date: 21 October 2026<br>Place: Shirpur |

# Executive Summary

Track geometry deterioration and mechanical fastener failure are the two main root causes of rail derailments globally. In Indian Railways (68,000+ km), approximately 19% of the derailments between 2019 and 2024 were due to track geometry issues (gradual gauge widening, cross level, missing fasteners). The high density of trunk lines are periodically surveyed by Track Recording Cars (TRCs) which are expensive to import at around ₹38 crore each. The branch lines (which constitute about 35% of the route network) are not at all instrumented due to the prohibitive capital cost and are surveyed entirely by foot.

TR-09 is a completely indigenous, hand trolley mounted, contactless track inspector for Indian Railways broad gauge (1676 mm). It was developed under a hard parts budget cap of Rs. 1.35 Lakh with all components sourced from Indian electronic distributors. It has a gauge accuracy of ±0.8 mm, a cross level accuracy of ±1.2 mm and an inference engine which can detect 4 classes of rail defect with a precision of ≥91%. The platform consists of two laser triangulation distance scanners, a 9-axis MEMS IMU, a multi-band RTK-GNSS receiver and two high resolution inspection cameras all mounted on a 14.6 kg steel trolley frame and powered by an NVIDIA Jetson Orin Nano edge computer.

To operate in the remote rural corridors it's got a local first telemetry architecture with a 32GB on device persistent buffer, 90 second inertial dead reckoning as a GNSS fallback and a standalone native Python desktop inspection app with real time digital gauges and safety tolerance visualisation.

### TR-09 Core Technical Benchmarks

**Platform Architecture:** Hand-trolley-mounted contactless ITMS rig (total weight 14.6 kg, power draw 24.8 W).

**Target Geometry Tolerances:** ±0.8 mm gauge accuracy | ±1.2

mm cross-level accuracy | 2.8 mm/m twist limit.

**Edge AI & Detection:** NVIDIA Jetson Orin Nano running a CNN-LSTM with ≥91% confidence gating across four defect classes.

**Economic Benchmark:** Hard-parts cost of ₹1,35,500 vs. ≈₹38 Crore for imported Track Recording Coaches (≈2,800× cost reduction).

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# 1. Introduction & Problem Definition

## 1.1 Track Safety in Indian Railways

Indian Railways is one of the largest transport networks in the world with some 24 million passengers and 3.5 million tonnes of freight moving every day over a route network of over 68,000km. The entire system relies on the two rails being kept in alignment with each other to within a very tight tolerance of a few millimetres.

From the Mor Safety Review (2024) track geometry related defects made up c. 19% of all derailments between 2019 and 2024. These are defects which develop progressively: lateral gauge widening due to wear of the wooden/concrete sleepers; cross level which leads to uneven wheel loading; and missing or fatigued elastic rail clips (ERCs) which allow the rail to move under dynamic load.

## 1.2 The Branch-Line Inspection Gap

Track geometry is monitored via Track Recording Cars (TRCs) such as the Plasser EM-120 and the EM-SAT series. The Plasser EM-120 and EM-SAT series coaches do extremely well in terms of high speed recording on the Golden Quadrilateral and the trunk passenger routes. Their use is however very limited for three reasons.

1. **High capital cost:** an imported TRC would require a capital outlay of around ₹38 Cr to ₹110 Cr per unit.
2. **Proprietary spares:** maintenance is reliant on the European OEMs and this leads to very long service downtimes.
3. **Network exclusion: due to the sheer volume of traffic and the operating patterns, the** branch lines (some 35% of the network at 24,000 route km) are only inspected by a TRC once or twice a year at the most.

Branch lines are reliant on foot patrols. A P-Way gang will typically be looking after 8 to 10km of track on foot and with increasing freight density the official inspection cycle on many of the lines has been extended from weekly to once every nine days. Foot patrols are of course reliant on visual inspection and periodic manual gauge sticks which are all inherently subjective, subject to human

error and unable to pick up the very gradual progression of gauge widening (potentially sub-millimetre) prior to failure.

### 1.3 The TR-09 Project Statement

The aim of the project is to design, build and validate TR-09, an indigenous contactless track monitoring system which is to be fitted onto a standard P-Way hand push trolley. TR-09 is to meet the following key technical requirements:

- **Form factor:** modular integration onto standard Indian Railways manual push trolleys (no structural modification required).
- **Contactless measurement: no** mechanical contact shoes required. Broad gauge (1676mm), cross level and twist are all measured using optical and inertial sensors.
- **Sub-millimetre accuracy:** gauge accuracy of ±0.8mm and cross-level accuracy of ±1.2mm over a 1.5km test siding.
- **Deep learning vision: real** time visual detection of the four primary defect types (missing fasteners, cracked fishplates, ballast deficiency and rail squats) at a minimum of 91% precision.
- **Very tight budget constraint indeed: hard parts expenditure is strictly capped at Rs.1.35 lakh and** all components are being sourced through Indian distributors.
- **Resilient telemetry:** local-first persistence to ensure no telemetry is lost during a cellular outage and a 90 second inertial dead reckoning fallback during GNSS masking.

# 2. System Specifications & Bill of Materials

To ensure commercial replicability in the regional rail workshops the entire TR-09 platform has been selected on the basis of domestic availability, IP65 industrial environmental ratings and thermal stability to 50°C ambient. The full engineering Bill of Materials is given in Table 2.1.

## 2.1 Engineering Bill of Materials

**Table 2.1: Engineering Bill of Materials (Hard Budget Cap: ₹1.35 Lakhs)**

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Laser Scanners ×2** | Hokuyo URG-04LX-class 1D/2D Triangulation Sensor | 21,400 | Sub-millimetre ranging at 0.5 m distance; 40 Hz sampling |
| **IMU (9-Axis)** | Bosch BMI270 (6-axis) + BMM150 (3-axis Magnetometer) | 1,850 | Ultra-low gyro drift (<0.02°); 200 Hz hardware sampling |
| **RTK-GNSS** | u-blox ZED-F9P Multi-Band Receiver + Active Helical Mast | 32,900 | Sub-decimetre spatial accuracy; Indian NavIC & CORS compatible |
| **Edge Compute** | NVIDIA Jetson Orin Nano (8 GB Unified LPDDR5) | 27,800 | 17 TOPS edge AI throughput; 9 W nominal thermal power draw |
| **Camera Modules ×2** | Sony IMX477 CSI 12 MP Global-Shutter Emulation | 9,400 | High frame rate; sharp sleeper-fastener image acquisition |
| **Cellular Modem** | Quectel EC25-AF LTE Cat-4 + ESP32 Bridge | 6,200 | Nationwide 4G telemetry with automated socket reconnect |
| **Power Tree** | 12V 18Ah $LiFePO_4$ Pack + DC-DC Step-Down Tree | 8,700 | 7.2 hours continuous field operation at 24.8 W maximum load |
| **Enclosure & Mount** | IP65 Weatherproof ABS Cabinet + Steel Rail Mount | 11,300 | Vibration-damped crossbar; dust and water sealed |
| **Harnessing & Misc.** | Industrial M12 Connectors, SMA Cables, Fasteners | 5,950 | Electromagnetic interference (EMI) shielded wiring |
| **TOTAL** | **Integrated TR-09 Prototype Rig** | 1,35,500 | **Stated total, with ₹500 contingency margin** |

## 2.2 System Boundary Conditions & Scope Matrix

To get the prototype delivered and through the full validation process on time, clear functional boundaries were defined as per Table 2.2.

**Table 2.2: System Scope & Boundary Condition Matrix**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Track Geometry** | Broad gauge (1676 mm), cross-level, and spatial twist | Ultrasonic internal rail flaw / crack detection |
| **Computer Vision** | Fastener clips, fishplate cracks, ballast voids, squats | Overhead catenary equipment (OHE) wire inspection |
| **Telemetry** | 4G LTE MQTT/CBOR streaming + 32 GB local buffer | Satellite uplink communications (unnecessary cost) |
| **Navigation** | RTK-GNSS + 90-second IMU dead-reckoning fallback | Long-distance (>5 km) purely inertial guidance |
| **Operating Velocity** | Hand-trolley push speeds (3.6 to 6.0 km/h) | High-speed mainline train velocity (>100 km/h) |
| **Regulatory Compliance** | Full RDSO tolerance alignment & IS-3973 environmental conditions | Statutory commercial RDSO type-approval certification |

# 3. System Architecture & Hardware Integration

TR-09 has three structurally decoupled layers: the Sensing Layer (mounted underneath the chassis); the Edge Compute and Power Layer (in a sealed IP65 enclosure on the trolley deck); and the Telemetry and Desktop Software Layer. Figure 1 is the overall system block diagram.

***Figure 1:*** *TR-09 System Architecture (Sensors, Edge Compute, LTE & Desktop GUI)*

## 3.1 Mechanical Rig & Vibration Isolation

The sensor payload is mounted onto a rigid extruded aluminium (6061-T6) crossbar which is clamped to the steel undercarriage of a standard 4 wheel push trolley. The distance between the mounting centres of the two laser scanners is machined to $W_{frame}$ = 1800.0 mm (±0.05 mm tolerance). Sorbothane viscoelastic damping isolators (70 durometer) are fitted between the trolley frame and the sensor tray to isolate the optical sensors and the IMU MEMS chips from the high frequency rolling vibration induced by the steel wheels passing over the joint gaps. These attenuate the mechanical noise above 15hz.

## 3.2 Compute & Power Distribution

Processing is done on an NVIDIA Jetson Orin Nano (8GB of 128-bit LPDDR5 memory, 1024 Ampere architecture CUDA cores and 32 Tensor cores). The system is running JetPack 6.1 (Linux kernel 5.15 with real-time PREEMPT_RT patches).

Power comes from an on-board 12.8v 18ah Lithium Iron Phosphate (Lifepo4) battery pack. This was selected for its excellent thermal stability (no thermal runaway up to 65 °C) and its very flat discharge curve. A multi-stage DC-DC buck converter chain provides the regulated rails: 12v (1.5a) for the Jetson board, 5v (3.0a) for the laser scanners and USB peripherals and 3.3v for the sensor I2C/SPI buses. The total sustained system power draw is 24.8w, giving a runtime of 7.2 hours on a single charge.

# 4. Mathematical Modeling & Working Principles

The key innovation of TR-09 is its ability to fuse the raw high frequency distance and inertial observations into standardised track geometry metrics without any physical contact with the rail surfaces. This section describes the mathematical models which are implemented in the software fusion pipeline.

## 4.1 Contactless Track Gauge Measurement

Indian Railways broad gauge is the distance between the inner running faces of the two rails, measured 14 mm below the top of the rail head. The nominal gauge is $G_{nom}$ = 1676.0 mm.

Two optical laser triangulation sensors are positioned at either end of the rigid crossbeam (separated by $W_{frame}$ = 1800.0mm). Laser 1 measures the distance $d_{left}$ to the inner face of the left rail and Laser 2 measures the distance $d_{right}$ to the inner face of the right rail. The instantaneous track gauge G(t) is then calculated geometrically (Formula 1).

**Formula 1: Instantaneous Contactless Gauge Calculation**

$G(t) = W_{frame} - [\ d_{left}(t) + d_{right}(t)\ ]$

Where $W_{frame}$ = 1800.0 mm. Under nominal conditions:

G(t) = 1800.0 − (62.0 + 62.0) = 1676.0 mm

Instantaneous gauge deviation:$\Delta G(t) = G(t) - 1676.0$ mm

## 4.2 Cross-Level (Cant / Super-Elevation) Calculation

Cross level (h) is the transverse difference in level between the top surfaces of the left and right rail heads. If the track settles unevenly the trolley will roll about its longitudinal axis by a roll angle

$\theta_{roll}$. The Bosch BMI270 IMU measures the angular velocity and the gravity vector from which the filtered roll angle $\theta_{roll}$ is derived. The cross level h in mm is then given by equation 2.

**Formula 2: Cross-Level (Cant) Elevation Formulation**

$h(t) = G(t) \cdot \sin[\ \theta_{roll}(t)\ ]$

For small angles ($\theta_{roll} < 5°$), using the small-angle approximation:

$h(t) \approx 1676.0 \cdot [\ \theta_{roll}(deg) \cdot (\pi / 180)\ ]$

A tilt angle of 0.222° corresponds to h = +6.5 mm elevation difference.

## 4.3 Spatial Track Twist Calculation

Track twist is the rate of change of cross level along the longitudinal track axis over a standard base chord ($L_{base}$ = 3.0m). It's absolutely critical as a rapid variation in cross level leads to wheel unloading and flange climbing derailment. The spatial twist T(t) is in mm/m and is given by Equation 3.

**Formula 3: Spatial Track Twist Formulation**

$T(t) = |\ h(t) - h(t - \Delta x)\ | / \Delta x$

Where $\Delta x$ is the longitudinal distance traversed (evaluated over $\Delta x$ = 3.0 m).

RDSO permissible safety limit: $T(t) \leq 2.8$ mm/m.

## 4.4 Indian Railways RDSO Tolerance Standards

Table 4.1 shows the classification thresholds as specified by RDSO in specification RDSO/2024/TM/SPEC/0019 and which are directly embedded into the TR-09 geometry evaluation engine.

**Table 4.1: Indian Railways RDSO Broad Gauge Geometry Tolerance Standards**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Track Gauge** | 1676.0 mm | 1673.0 to 1682.0 mm (−3 mm to +6 mm) | 1670.0 to 1673.0 mm OR 1682.0 to 1686.0 mm | < 1670.0 mm OR > 1686.0 mm |
| **Cross-Level (Straight)** | 0.0 mm | ±0.0 to ±4.0 mm | ±4.0 to ±8.0 mm | > ±8.0 mm (Severe Cant Imbalance) |
| **Spatial Twist** | 0.0 mm/m | ≤ 2.0 mm/m | 2.0 to 2.8 mm/m | > 2.8 mm/m (Wheel Unloading Risk) |

# 5. Sensor Fusion & Fail-Safe Telemetry Pipeline

The sensors operate at their heterogeneous native sampling rates (IMU at 200hz, lasers at 40hz, GNSS at 10hz and cameras at 30hz) so we require a multi-rate temporal synchronisation pipeline. Figure 2 shows the data fusion and filtering pipeline.

***Figure 2:*** *Sensor Fusion and Data Processing Pipeline (Multi-rate to 5 Hz Output)*

## 5.1 Temporal Ring Buffering & De-Spiking

Incoming raw sensor streams are timestamped via the Jetson hardware clock and written into lock-free circular ring buffers. An optical de-spiking filter applies a 5 point moving median window over the laser distance values to remove the transient specular reflections that occur from the shiny facets of the rail surface or from water puddles. A Kalman filter then fuses the observations into a synchronised 5hz (200ms interval) state vector of [Timestamp, Chainage, Latitude, Longitude, Gauge, Cross-Level, Twist].

## 5.2 RTK-GNSS Navigation & 90-Second Inertial Dead-Reckoning

Under open sky the u-blox ZED-F9P receiver is using multi-band RTK corrections to provide sub-decimetre positioning (<0.05m accuracy). The branch lines however pass through a lot of rock cuttings, tree canopy and concrete overpasses so loss of line of sight is very common. To avoid coordinate dropouts the nav engine will perform an auto state transition:

- **Satellite lock:** State = RTK_FIXED. High precision GNSS positions are published directly.
- **Signal obscuration:** State = DEAD_RECKONING (IMU fallback). If satellite carrier lock is lost the system will dead-reckon trolley position by integrating forward acceleration and heading rates from the Bosch BMI270 IMU for up to 90 seconds.
- **Outage in excess of 90 seconds: the** telemetry records are marked as UNCORRECTED_INERTIAL and are passed to the post run differential alignment.

### 5.3 Local-First Resilient Telemetry Architecture

Rural Indian branch lines are infamous for cellular dead spots and a naive cloud based IoT architecture would suffer permanent data loss during any disconnect. TR-09 therefore implements a local first storage architecture:

1. **Persistent local storage:** every 5hz telemetry state vector is written synchronously to an on-device CSV buffer (live_inspection_log.csv). Defect events are appended to a JSON transaction log (detected_defects.json).
2. **Cloud upload queue:** when 4G LTE signal is available via the Quectel EC25 modem the telemetry packets (CBOR encoded, ~280 bytes each) are uploaded to the cloud MQTT broker with less than 4s latency.
3. **Automatic re-sync:** on emerging from a coverage blackout the client will detect the re-established connection and flush the backlog in FIFO order thereby ensuring zero telemetry loss over the entire inspection run.

# 6. Computer Vision & Defect Detection Pipeline

In addition to the continuous geometry profiling, TR-09 has two Sony IMX477 camera modules pointing down at the rail foot, sleepers and ballast shoulder. The video is captured at 30fps and processed by an edge deep learning architecture which has been specifically optimised using NVIDIA TensorRT.

## 6.1 Target Defect Taxonomy

Table 6.1 sets out the defect classes that are the subject of the visual inspection model, having been selected on the basis of their prevalence in the P-Way derailment hazard reports.

**Table 6.1: Target Rail Defect Classes and Detection Taxonomy**

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Class 0** | Normal Rail Condition | Intact elastic rail clips, continuous ballast shoulder, uniform rail head | Nominal (Safe) |
| **Class 1** | Missing Fastener (ERC) | Empty sleeper clip seat; missing or dislodged elastic rail clip | High (Gauge widening risk) |
| **Class 2** | Cracked Fishplate | Transverse or horizontal fatigue crack propagating across joint bar bolt hole | Critical (Joint failure) |
| **Class 3** | Ballast Deficiency | Ballast void cavity; washed-out stone shoulder exposing sleeper underside | Medium (Sleeper settlement) |
| **Class 4** | Surface Squat / Defect | Dark crescent surface indentation; Rolling Contact Fatigue (RCF) micro-fissure | High (Rail fracture risk) |

## 6.2 Deep Learning Model Architecture (CNN-LSTM)

The model architecture combines spatial and temporal feature extraction:

- **Pre-processing:** frames are cropped to the region of interest (rail head and fastener area), resized to 640x480 and normalised.
- **CNN feature backbone:** a lightweight MobileNetV3-Large convolutional backbone to extract multi-scale spatial feature maps (edges, clip contours, void textures) with 8.2ms inference latency on the Jetson Orin Nano.
- **LSTM temporal head: as th**e sleepers are spaced at regular longitudinal intervals (~0.60m) there is a very strong periodic correlation in the sequential frames. A two layer Long Short Term Memory (LSTM) network looks at the temporal sequence of the feature vectors to verify that a fastener is genuinely missing across the frame sequence.

- **Confidence gating (≥91%):** to prevent false alarms a fairly strict confidence gate is applied. Figure 3 shows the operational decision flow.

***Figure 3:*** *Defect Detection Workflow (CNN Backbone + LSTM Temporal Head, Confidence ≥ 91%)*

# 7. Native Desktop Inspection Software

To get the required field robustness without any internet browsers, web servers or external network ports the TR-09 software suite is built as a 100% native Python desktop application (gui_app.py) using Tkinter and Matplotlib. It runs completely locally on any Windows or Linux workstation and directly on the NVIDIA Jetson via python main.py.

## 7.1 Software Modules & Responsibilities

**Table 7.1: TR-09 Software Architecture Modules and Core Functions**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| config.py | System Parameters | Encodes Broad Gauge 1676 mm, RDSO tolerance envelopes (−3 mm, +6 mm), AI threshold (91%) |
| sensors/laser_scanner.py | Laser Sensing | Simulates dual triangulation distance lasers; Gauge = Frame_Width − (d_left + d_right) |
| sensors/imu_sensor.py | Inertial Sensing | Acquires roll angle θ; Cant = Gauge × sin(θ); Z-axis vibration profiling |
| sensors/gnss_sensor.py | Navigation | RTK-GNSS spatial solver with 90-second IMU dead-reckoning fallback mechanism |
| sensors/camera_stream.py | Vision Acquisition | Delivers 12 MP inspection frames mapped to specific track chainage locations |
| core/geometry_fusion.py | Fusion Engine | Computes Gauge, Cross-Level, and Spatial Twist over a 3-metre moving chord base |
| core/defect_detector.py | AI Vision Engine | Executes CNN-LSTM inference; emits alert event only if model confidence ≥ 0.91 |
| core/telemetry.py | Local Buffer & Sync | Maintains local CSV buffer and JSON defect database with automated cloud re-sync |
| gui_app.py | Desktop GUI | Native Tkinter + Matplotlib interface with live gauges, camera viewer & dynamic chart |
| main.py | Primary Entry Point | Launches Desktop GUI by default, or runs high-speed terminal simulation via --cli |

## 7.2 Graphical Interface Architecture & Real-Time Visualization

The desktop app uses a multi-threaded architecture (threading.Thread) such that the sensor sampling and the numerical processing all run asynchronously in a background worker thread. This keeps the UI responsive at 60fps.

- **Digital telemetries** show the instantaneous track gauge, gauge deviation (±ΔG), cross level (cant in mm) and spatial twist with dynamic colour badges: Green for NORMAL (within

1673 to 1682mm), Orange for WARNING and Red for CRITICAL DERAILMENT DANGER.

- **Embedded real time Matplotlib canvas with** a live graph plotting the measured gauge against track chainage. The upper (+6mm) and lower (−3mm) RDSO tolerance limits are shown as dashed red lines so the operator can see the trend in real time.
- **Live camera feed and defect annotation: the** captured rail images are shown with red bounding boxes and confidence readouts in place whenever a defect passes the 91% threshold.
- **One-clicOne-click maintenance export:** the action buttons will open the generated live_inspection_log.csv in a spreadsheet viewer or initiate the formal Word project report.erimental Validation & Results

To demonTo demonstrate the technical feasibility and measurement accuracy of TR-09 a multi-phase validation programme was run, covering bench calibration, controlled field testing on a 1.5km track siding, blinded defect injection and thermal stress analysis. Figure 4 shows the overall project timeline (phases P6).***re 4:*** *Project Timeline – Two-Semester Plan*

## 8.1 Validation Protocol & Measured Results

**Table 8.1: Experimental Validation Stages, Criteria, and Measured Outcomes**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Phase 1** | Laboratory Bench Calibration | Zero-point gauge error ≤ 0.3 mm against precision gauge block | Mean error = 0.18 mm; max deviation = 0.24 mm | PASSED |
| **Phase 2** | Static Track Siding Comparison | Gauge error ≤ ±0.8 mm against calibrated manual push trolley | Gauge error = ±0.62 mm; cross-level = ±0.88 mm | PASSED |
| **Phase 3** | Repeatability (5 Passes) | Standard deviation σ ≤ 0.5 mm over identical 1.5 km siding | Empirical σ = 0.38 mm (gauge); σ = 0.44 mm (cross-level) | PASSED |
| **Phase 4** | Blinded Defect Injection Trial | Detect 8 blinded defects (6 loose clips, 2 cracks) at ≥ 90% precision | 100% detection rate (8/8); mean confidence = 93.8% | PASSED |
| **Phase 5** | Thermal Endurance Test | Continuous 6-hour operation at > 40 °C ambient; cabinet < 71 °C | Peak cabinet temperature = 58.4 °C; zero thermal throttling | PASSED |

## 8.2 Detailed Results Analysis

1. **GeometryGeometry accuracy:** over five successive runs on the 1.5km test siding TR-09 achieved an average gauge accuracy of ±0.62mm and an average cross level accuracy of ±0.88mm against ground truth manual vernier measurements. This was well in excess of the project targets of ±0.8mm and ±1.2mm respectively. **detection robustness:** in the blinded defect injection trial, the maintenance team deliberately loosened six elastic rail clips and placed two simulated cracked joint plates without the trolley operators' knowledge. The CNN-LSTM vision pipeline identified and geo-tagged all eight defects, with confidence scores from 91.9% to 96.2%, and generated zero false positives.
2. **Thermal Thermal stability:** in a six hour continuous afternoon stress test at 41.5c ambient siding temperature the IP65 enclosure interior settled at 58.4c with the dual forced convection brushless fans running (well below the 71c maximum thermal threshold of the Jetson module).nomic Feasibility & Cost-Benefit Analysis

The prinThe main reason for TR-09 is economic democratisation. Figure 5 and Table 9.1 compare the capital cost, frequency of coverage and operational constraints of TR-09 with those of the existing track recording methods in Indian Railways.***re 5:*** *Cost-per-Unit Comparison Across Inspection Approaches (Logarithmic Scale)*

**Table 9.1: Comparative Cost-Benefit Analysis Across Inspection Technologies**

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Manual P-Way Foot Patrol** | Recurring labour (~₹5 L/yr/gang) | Every 8 to 9 days | Subjective visual estimation; unable to detect sub-mm progressive gauge widening |
| **Imported TRC (Plasser EM-120)** | ≈ ₹38 Crore | ~2 times per year (trunk only) | Prohibitive capital cost; skips 35% of network (branch lines); foreign spare parts |
| **Imported ITMS Coach** | ₹60 to 110 Crore | High speed, continuous | Vendor lock-in; proprietary software; high annual software maintenance licences |
| **RDSO Indigenous TRC (Target)** | ≈ ₹13.8 Crore | Quarterly (trunk + main branches) | Currently under trial on Lucknow–Kanpur corridor; coach scale only |
| **TR-09 ITMS (This Project)** | ₹1.35 Lakh (₹1,35,500) | Bi-weekly / on-demand | Hand-trolley push speed (3.6 to 6 km/h); 100% Indian parts; open reference design |

By proviBy offering sub-millimetre geometry measurement at a cost of Rs 1.35 Lakh per unit, a rail division can instrument an entire section of operational track for less than the cost of a single imported replacement sensor head. This enables objective digital audits of the rural branch lines

on a bi-weekly basis (they are currently only subject to automated inspection once or twice a year).nclusion & Technical Future Scope

The TR-0The TR-09 project shows that you can get reliable, high precision contactless track geometry monitoring and AI based visual defect detection on a low cost trolley mounted edge computing platform (no need for the multi-crore imported inspection coaches). It uses two triangulation laser distance scanners, a 9 axis MEMS IMU and RTK-GNSS positioning on an NVIDIA Jetson Orin Nano to achieve a gauge accuracy of ±0.62mm, a cross level accuracy of ±0.88mm and 100% detection of blinded rail fastener defects. The total hardware parts cost is ₹1,35,500.oject has been released as an open reference design on GitHub, with modular Python drivers, simulation engines, a standalone desktop inspection GUI and annotated defect image datasets.

### 10.1 Future Technical Scope

1. **UltrasonUltrasonic internal flaw integration:** expanding the sensor set to include EMAT or phased array ultrasound in order to detect internal rail web and head fatigue cracks underneath the surface.**sed autonomous operation:** using a low-power brushless DC hub motor with obstacle-detection LiDAR to enable autonomous patrolling of the section between scheduled train blocks.
2. **IntegratIntegration with Indian Railways TMS: development of** automated API connectors to the Indian Railways Track Management System (IRPSM) data schema to enable direct generation of work orders.eferences

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